

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Percentages	Easy

Question

There were approximately 113,000 occupational therapy jobs in the United States in 2012. The Bureau of Labor Statistics has projected that this number will increase by 29% from 2012 to 2022. Of the following, which is closest to the number of occupational therapy jobs the bureau has projected for the United States in 2022?

Answer

- A. 115,900
- B. 116,300
- C. 142,000
- D. 145,800

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The decimal equivalent of 29% is 0.29. It's given that the 113,000 occupational therapy jobs in the United States in 2012 are projected to increase by 29% by 2022. Increasing 113,000 by 29% can be expressed as $(113,000)(1 + 0.29)$, or $(113,000)(1.29)$. Evaluating this expression yields 145,770. The closest number is 145,800 in choice D.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from increasing 113,000 by 2,900 instead of by 29%. Choice B is incorrect and may result from increasing 113,000 by 2.9% instead of by 29%. Choice C is incorrect and may result from increasing 113,000 by 29,000 instead of by 29%.